Sumit Deshmukh

Senior Product Leader · Marketplaces, Creator Economy, AI Platforms

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Senior Product Leader with 12 years building AI, payments, and marketplace products across SaaS and consumer tech. Led a $100M+ Creator Marketing portfolio at Bazaarvoice across 4 engineering teams; built the company's first payments platform; drove an AI-native product transformation across search, tagging, and agentic prototypes. First PM at Affable.ai: built the product function from scratch, grew ARR ~2.7x, and led it through acquisition by Bazaarvoice (2023).

Key Accomplishments

- Led an AI-native product transformation across Creator Marketing: AI-powered creator search and discovery, an intelligent product-tagging model (6x accuracy improvement across a 25-client pilot), an AI evaluation framework, and the first agentic campaign prototype, while upskilling the team on LLMs and RAG.
- Built and led the product organization at Affable.ai from scratch: hired and coached a team of 7 PMs and designers, set the planning cadence and roadmap process, and drove the company through acquisition by Bazaarvoice (2023).
- Led Creator Marketing within Content & Creators, a portfolio carrying $100M+ in non-recurring revenue and ~$26.5M ARR, with 2 PMs and 4 designers and execution across 4 engineering teams and 20+ engineers.
- Launched the first money-movement capability for a $350M+ revenue enterprise. This solved a critical gap that had stalled 24 major deals and was cited in 28% of historical losses; the platform successfully processed ~$125K in payouts at a 99% success rate, achieving 4.2x monthly growth.
- Architected Integrated Sampling, a managed offering unifying a 9.5M+ member sampling community, brand ambassadors, and paid creators into a single product. This platform powers the Influenster and campaign infrastructure behind 3B+ monthly social impressions and anchors a $16M YoY growth category.
- Launched BMS Stream (transactional VoD) at BookMyShow during the pandemic; scaled it to ~80% of company revenue at ~30% MoM growth.

Experience

Bazaarvoice · Senior Manager, Product (Associate Director), Creator Marketing Sep 2023 – Jun 2026

Led the Creator Marketing portfolio inside Vibe, Bazaarvoice's unified Sampling, Creator Marketing, and Social Commerce platform. Team of 2 PMs and 4 designers; execution across 4 engineering teams (20+ engineers).

- Shaped multi-year product strategy: authored the investment cases that set quarterly portfolio priorities, made durable build-vs-buy and architecture calls (licensed-partner payments model; direct affiliate integration), defined the 18-month roadmap, and led the post-acquisition integration of Affable into Vibe.
- Built Creator Payments end-to-end, Bazaarvoice's first money-mover platform; ~$125K volume, 99% payment success, and ~4.2x monthly growth within four months of launch. Recovered 28% of previously lost Affable deals and unblocked 24 stalled commercial conversations.
- Led Creator Search, the AI-powered natural-language discovery engine used by every enterprise client: demographic model accuracy 72% → 93%, search latency down ~68%, an evaluation framework that made search quality measurable, and a GARM-aligned Creator Brand Safety Score.
- Shipped the Sampling Campaign Agent, an automated conversational tool replacing a seven-step manual request flow. Architected the system to separate knowledge retrieval from workflow logic, with

deterministic business rules and a 'prepare-and-review' release phase to ensure all AI outputs remained verifiable.

- Hired and coached PMs and designers and set the team's operating cadences; authored the C&C-wide PRD template and reviewer matrix, adopted across three product units.
- Coached the team through the broader roadmap: Intelligent Product Tagging (6x accuracy improvement across 25 enterprise pilot clients; both phased OKR targets met), Content Approval, and Email Whitelisting.

Affable.ai · Associate Director, Product Sep 2021 – Sep 2023

First product hire; acquired by Bazaarvoice. Set up the product function from scratch; hired and led a team of 7 PMs and designers, established the planning cadence and roadmap process, and drove Affable through acquisition.

- Led the product's evolution from creator discovery to end-to-end creator management, the bet that anchored the acquisition: campaigns and CRM, native email outreach, Shopify/Magento/Gmail/Outlook integrations, and a white-labeled Creator Portal for brand–creator collaboration, opt-ins, and automated product shipping.
- Built the company-defining AI Creator Search: semantic, visual, multilingual, and lookalike retrieval across a 10M+ creator index (Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, Facebook, X), with audience-quality and fraud scoring, sentiment analytics, and ROI attribution.
- Grew Affable ARR ~2.7x through to acquisition; the product became the creator sourcing engine inside Bazaarvoice Vibe.

BookMyShow · Product Manager, BMS Stream Jul 2019 – Aug 2021

- Led BMS Stream (transactional VoD) at India's largest out-of-home entertainment platform (100M+ downloads). The company's central bet during the pandemic; scaled to ~80% of company revenue at ~30% MoM growth, anchored by marquee direct-to-digital premieres (DC, Marvel) that drove 140K+ transactions in a month at 20x revenue growth.
- Owned growth and discovery across web, mobile, and TV — checkout, cross-device streaming, 4K, and DRM playback reliability; authored the TVOD growth strategy on organic-adoption and repeat-rate metrics.

Earlier 2014 – 2017

Co-founder, Incent Social (shoppable UGC SaaS; IIT Gandhinagar–incubated, seed-funded) · Product Manager, Testbook.com · Associate, ZoomRx.

Education

B.Tech, Indian Institute of Technology Gandhinagar 2010 – 2014

Major: Mechanical Engineering (8.3/10) · Minor: Management (9.2/10)

Skills

Product Strategy: Portfolio management, roadmap prioritization, product discovery, experimentation, 0→1 builds, post-acquisition integration, OKRs, PRDs, stakeholder management, executive communication.

People Leadership: Hiring and coaching PMs and designers, structured onboarding, performance management, operating cadences.

AI Capabilities: LLMs and RAG, embeddings and vector search, semantic and visual retrieval, agentic workflows, MCP and tool integration, AI evaluation frameworks and golden sets, human-in-the-loop review; SQL, A/B testing, analytics.